

The Diversities of Tongues

Diverse Tongues Must Be Understood From the Government of God

If we are going to understand the importance diversities of tongues plays in God's government, we must take it from the Word of God.

If you understand what I am about to tell you, you will never again let anyone discredit or remove diversities of tongues from its important place in the government of God. Nor will you let anyone talk you out of the importance of praying in the Holy Ghost.

The Father has promised me something I can pass on to you: if you continue faithfully getting to know God by His Spirit, five years from now you will not look back and find that your life has been the same day after day, month after month, unchanged and defeated. If you pursue Him by the Spirit, growth and change will come.

So let us look closely at the role diversities of tongues plays in His government and in His ability to set us free.

The Nine Gifts Empower Eight Operations

First Corinthians 12 says:

Now concerning spiritual gifts, brethren, I would not have you ignorant.

If there is one area where I do not want to be ignorant, it is the operation of the gifts of the Spirit. And when Paul says he would not have us ignorant, before he finishes the chapter he will supply enough information to eradicate ignorance.

As faith and Pentecostal people, we often pride ourselves on knowing there are nine gifts of the Spirit. It would be better if we knew more about operating in them.

The nine gifts empower eight total operations of God. Those eight operations are divided into three categories.

Paul says:

Now ye are the body of Christ, and members in particular.

If you are born again and filled with the Holy Ghost, you are called and separated in your spirit to fulfill one or more of these operations. One of them is yours.

Diversities of Tongues Is a Whole Operation, Not a Side Issue

First Corinthians 12:28 says:

And God hath set some in the church, first apostles, secondarily prophets, thirdly teachers...

Then Paul lists miracles, gifts of healings, helps, governments, and diversities of tongues.

We hear much about pastors, evangelists, teachers, prophets, and apostles. We hear about helps and governments. But the operation we know very little about is diversities of tongues.

Why? Because the devil is afraid of it and has run around the country trying to discredit it.

Some say you are not getting anywhere with God in tongues unless you are in a warring tongue, shouting at the devil. The problem is that the Word says when you pray in tongues, you are not speaking to men but to God. You do not need to shout tongues at God, because He is not deaf. And if you do shout, He is not nervous.

Whether you whisper or shout, the supernatural language created in your spirit means the same thing when it leaves your mouth. Emotions are added as the tongue passes through the soul realm. I do not mind emotion, but emotion is not what gives tongues their power.

The devil has tried to confuse tongues so believers will become discouraged and stop using them. Yet God gave an entire operation in His government to diversities of tongues.

Four Diversities Serve Different Purposes

"Diversities" means different supernatural flows or manifestations of tongues.

The first is tongues for personal edification. This is the one most believers are familiar with.

The second is tongues for interpretation in a public assembly.

The third is tongues that extend into deep intercessional groanings of the Spirit, empowering you to stand in the gap for your life, your family, your city, or your nation.

The fourth is tongues as a sign to the unbeliever, when the Holy Spirit empowers you to testify, preach, or witness in a language you have never learned. When you preach in someone's native language by the Spirit, that is a sign to the unbeliever personified.

God calls it diversities of tongues because it is an entire operation with multiple manifestations, placed in His government to serve a purpose. To deny it is to deny part of the perfecting of the body of Christ.

The First Category Matures the Saints Through the Word

The first category includes apostle, prophet, teacher, workings of miracles, and gifts of healings. It also encompasses the evangelist and pastor.

This category is given for the maturing of the saints because these ministries handle the Word of God. The Word brings believers from milk to strong meat, increases faith, instructs, and corrects.

Ephesians 4 says:

And he gave some, apostles; and some, prophets; and some, evangelists; and some, pastors and teachers;
For the perfecting of the saints...

The fivefold ministry is given for the perfecting, or maturing, of the saints.

The Second Category Carries the Work of the Ministry

The second category is helps and governments. Ephesians 4 continues:

...for the work of the ministry...

Helps and governments are given for the work of the ministry.

The body cannot function only through pulpit gifts. Helps and governments organize, support, carry, administer, and make room for the work to be done. They are not lesser gifts. They are part of the government of God.

The Third Category Edifies the Body of Christ

The third category is diversities of tongues, and it is given:

...for the edifying of the body of Christ:
Till we all come in the unity of the faith...

If we exclude the third category, how will we come into the unity of the faith?

Every believer has access to tongues for personal edification. No matter what operation you are called to fulfill, this third category belongs to you. The Holy Spirit has been placed within you and is willing to pray mysteries and divine secrets through your spirit hour after hour, building you spiritually into the operation God separated you to at your rebirth.

We have heard extended teaching on apostles, prophets, pastors, teachers, evangelists, helps, and governments. But where is the extended teaching on the role diversities of tongues plays in edifying the body of Christ?

It takes all three categories for us to arrive at the unity of the faith.

Ministry Gifts Are Servants, Not Celebrities

For a long time, the way I heard government taught fed pride instead of humility. People would say the fivefold gifts were given to mature the saints so the saints could do the work of the ministry and the body could be edified. But it all seemed to run back up the ladder to how great the pulpit gift was.

When God first moved me into another phase of ministry, camp meetings opened to me, and I began to think I was something among them. My wife caught it first. Wives often see it first when you start getting funny.

In one meeting, I was asked to receive offerings in services where other men were preaching. Some of those men did not come in during the offering, and it began to bother me. In an elevator, a person said, "They ought to hear you teach." I said, "Yes, if they hung around long enough, they would." My wife heard it and corrected me.

The teaching I had received on government was not helping. It made the ministry gift sound like the special one, while everyone else existed to support the gift.

But the Lord showed me that was not what He was saying. Your calling and office are as precious and important to the body as mine. I am called to serve spiritual things from His table to you. That is my job for your maturing. But your office is just as important as mine, and you should not be treated with disrespect.

Christ Gave All Three Categories for the Body's Full Operation

Ephesians 4 says that when Jesus ascended on high, He gave gifts to men.

To clarify, imagine He ascended three times, once for each category. The first time, He gave apostles, prophets, evangelists, pastors, and teachers. Certain people in the body stood up and said, "I received the apostle's gift," "I received the prophet's gift," or "I received the teaching gift."

Then Jesus looked at the body and said, "It is not enough." So He gave helps and governments, and thousands stood up saying they had received gifts to carry the work of the ministry.

Then He looked again and said, "They still must learn to operate out of My Spirit." So He gave diversities of tongues. This time, every believer could stand up and say, "I have received tongues for personal edification." Some also received tongues for interpretation, some deep intercessional groanings, and some tongues as a sign to the unbeliever.

All believers need the third category because all believers need edification by the Holy Spirit.

The Spirit Builds Each Believer Into the Operation God Ordained

The Spirit of grace says: When I call and separate you through ordination into an operation I have placed in the body, My power will qualify you to fulfill that office from within. I have made all things possible to him who believes.

Do not approach My presence in your own understanding, or only with the ideas, creeds, and doctrines men put forth. I have placed within you truth and an anointing which cannot lie and will teach you all things.

Yield yourself to My Spirit for the purposes of edification. I will lift you up, build you into every operation I separated you to, and qualify you by My power.

The Eighth Operation Has Little Glory but Great Power

There is not enough visible glory in the eighth operation for many people. Lock yourself away and pray hour after hour where nobody knows about it. Where is the glory?

There is glory in being known as an apostle, prophet, teacher, or miracle worker. But diversities of tongues for personal edification often happens hidden before God.

So people run from church to church, changing circumstances, when the one needing change is themselves. When will we stop and begin transforming into what we have heard? When will we put our feet on the rock and say, "I am tired of being shoved around. I will meet the devil here and fight until I come out"?

God gave you the eighth operation, the Word of God, and the rest of His government so you can stand and fight. He gave an entire operation for your edification. Why not use it?

Prayer Changes the Fourteen Hours That Seem to Consume You

Someone says, "I am busy scratching out a living. I work fourteen hours."

Unless you want to work fourteen hours the rest of your life, put in a couple hours later with God. Those two hours will change the fourteen.

Some of you are frustrated. You have been beating the air so long your confidence has been destroyed. You moved from church to church looking for answers. Often we look for someone who will agree with us, but that person usually wants our money.

I could tickle your ears and conform myself to popular doctrines if I wanted to draw people. But that would not mean I had your best interest at heart.

If I love you, I will teach you to take a stand, put your feet on the rock, and say, "No more. Changing my circumstances has not been the answer. I must transform to the Word I have been hearing so my ministry can be released."

Diversities of Tongues Edifies Us Into Unity and Fruitfulness

The Holy Spirit's continual speaking of mysteries and divine secrets through your spirit causes the Word of God to come alive in you. That brings edification to the body of Christ. It purges what is unlovely in us, teaches us to love one another, and brings us into unity supplied by the power of the Holy Spirit.

You cannot come Sunday morning and pray for hours, or come Wednesday night and pray, or spend days driving and praying in tongues without something deep and weighty working in you.

God's third category is working wonderfully in you. Your seed is germinating. The image is coming out. Stalks, leaves, and small fruits begin to form. Joy, peace, longsuffering, and the great peace of serving God begin to come forth.

Stay in. Revival is coming too.

Are you understanding better the role diversities of tongues plays in the government of God?